PHP 6 has been in development since October of 2006. The most significant change will be native support for Unicode. Unpopular, deprecated features such as Magic Quotes, register_globals, safe_mode, and the HTTP_*_VARS variables will disappear in PHP 6. Although PHP is still primarily used for server-side generation of Web pages, it can also be used to perform command-line scripting or to create graphical applications with the help of GTK+.

1.2 PHP INSTALLATION

In order to develop and run PHP Web pages three vital components need to be installed on your computer system.

- ***Web Server*** – PHP will work with virtually all Web Server software, including Microsoft's Internet Information Server (IIS) but then most often used is freely available Apache Server.
- ***Database*** – PHP will work with virtually all database software, including Oracle and Sybase but most commonly used is freely available MySQL database.
- ***PHP Parser*** – In order to process PHP script instructions a parser must be installed to generate HTML output that can be sent to the **Web Browser**.

Keyword

Web browser is a software application for accessing information on the World Wide Web.

1.2.1 PHP Parser Installation

Before you proceed it is important to make sure that you have proper environment setup on your machine to develop your web programs using PHP.

Type the following address into your browser's address box.

http://127.0.0.1/info.php

If this displays a page showing your PHP installation related information then it means you have PHP and Webserver installed properly. Otherwise you have to follow given procedure to install PHP on your computer.

We will guide you to install and configure PHP over the following four platforms –

- PHP Installation on Linux or Unix with Apache